

Whole steps

A whole step is the equivalent of two half steps in music. While a half step will go just to the adjacent key, whether black or white, a whole step always skips a note. Two notes a whole step apart always have one note between them on the keyboard.

SEE ALSO

◀ 48–51 Sharps and flats

◀ 52–53 Half steps

Major scales

60–61 ▶

Whole steps on the keyboard

If a note moves up a whole step, it skips over the note immediately above it to the next note on the keyboard. The note one half step above could be a black key or a white key, depending on the starting note.

▷ Whole step

C and D are a whole step apart because they have a black key (C $\sharp$ or D $\flat$) between them. F $\sharp$ and G $\sharp$ have a white key (G) between them. B and C $\sharp$ have C $\flat$ between them.

▽ On the staff

This is how the three whole steps shown on the keyboard are written on the staff.

